So, when he went on television, the dismal situation reflected on his face. His eyes were grave and his words, measured. He admonished the attitude which had developed in the community—the attitude that India has escaped the wrath of the virus and that life should go on as is. He warned that this attitude would cost Indians many lives.

> Till now, science has not been able to find a definite solution to save us from the Corona pandemic, neither has a vaccine been developed. In such a situation, it is very natural to get worried. Study of the countries most affected by Corona virus has revealed another aspect. In these countries, the spread of the disease has witnessed almost an explosion after the initial few days. The number of people infected by Corona has grown at a rapid pace. The Government is tracking the spread of the disease around the world closely. And we see that there are a few countries which have controlled the situation by taking swift decisions and isolating its people as much as possible. This burgeoning crisis of Corona is not an ordinary occurrence for a nation like India with a population of 130 crore, striving for development. Therefore, as we witness the wide-spread impact of the Corona pandemic even in major, developed countries today, it is wrong to assume that India will not be impacted by it.[20]

He went on to explain that preventing one's self from contracting the disease was the best measure at this point, in the absence of proven treatments or vaccines. And the way to do that would be to follow 'social distancing'.

> During such a pandemic, only one mantra can take us through: '*Hum swasth, toh jag swasth* (If we are healthy, the world will be healthy, too)'. Patience is an essential virtue to avoid this disease, and keep oneself healthy. Practising this patience would mean staying away from crowds and avoiding leaving your homes. This is called 'social distancing' nowadays, and is critical in these times of the global corona pandemic. Our determination and patience will play a crucial role in containing the impact of this global pandemic. It is wrong if you believe that you are okay and nothing can happen to you, that you can continue roaming around in markets and streets as usual and remain unaffected. By doing this, you will not only be